

Tab 1

Core Roguelite Elements:

- **Procedural Generation:**
 - This is a cornerstone. Levels, items, and enemy placements are randomized, ensuring each playthrough feels unique.
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- **Permadeath (with Progression):**
 - While Roguelikes are known for strict permadeath, Roguelites often soften this by introducing persistent progression. This might involve:
 - Unlocking new items, abilities, or characters.
 - Upgrading base stats or facilities.
 - Gaining knowledge that aids future runs.
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- **Run-Based Structure:**
 - Gameplay is typically divided into distinct "runs," where the player attempts to progress as far as possible before inevitable failure.
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- **Variety and Replayability:**
 - The combination of procedural generation and persistent progression encourages multiple playthroughs, with each run offering new challenges and opportunities.
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- **Emphasis on Player Skill and Adaptation:**
 - While randomness plays a role, success in a Roguelite often relies on the player's ability to adapt to unexpected situations and make strategic decisions.
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Incorporating a Core Digging Mechanic:

A digging mechanic can add a fascinating layer to a Roguelite, opening up new possibilities for exploration, resource gathering, and strategic gameplay. Here's how you could incorporate it:

- **Environmental Manipulation:**
 - **Creating Paths:** Players could dig through walls or obstacles to create shortcuts or access hidden areas.
 - **Resource Gathering:** Digging could yield valuable resources, such as minerals, ores, or rare materials.
 - **Terrain Modification:** Players could alter the terrain to create defensive positions, traps, or escape routes.
- **Strategic Depth:**
 - **Risk vs. Reward:** Digging could be time-consuming or risky, exposing players to dangers but offering significant rewards.

- **Environmental Hazards:** Digging could trigger traps, release enemies, or uncover hazardous materials.
- **Digging Tools and Upgrades:** Implement a system of digging tools with varying properties, allowing for upgrades that increase efficiency, range, or special abilities.
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- **Procedural Generation Integration:**
 - **Diggable Layers:** Generate levels with varying layers of diggable materials, each with unique properties and resources.
 - **Hidden Chambers:** Randomly generate hidden chambers or tunnels that can only be accessed through digging.
 - **Dynamic Terrain:** Allow the terrain to dynamically change as players dig, creating emergent gameplay scenarios.
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- **Roguelite Progression:**
 - **Permanent Tool Upgrades:** Allow players to unlock permanent upgrades for their digging tools, increasing their effectiveness in future runs.
 - **New Digging Abilities:** Introduce new digging abilities or techniques that can be unlocked through progression.
 - **Resource Persistence:** Allow players to retain certain resources gathered through digging between runs, providing a sense of persistent progression.

Examples of Digging Mechanic uses:

- Imagine a roguelite where you are trying to reach the core of a planet. Digging would be the main way to progress, but you would have to manage oxygen, and heat, while dealing with the planets native hostile lifeforms.
- Imagine a roguelite where you are a dwarf, that is trying to find a legendary lost treasure, that is hidden deep within a mountain. Digging would be your primary way of exploring, and finding new areas, and new dangers.

By carefully considering these elements, you can create a compelling Roguelite experience that seamlessly integrates a core digging mechanic.

Orebit - Game Design Document

Game Design Document

Overview

In this roguelite space-mining survival game, players choose from three unique planets per run to mine resources, battle enemies, and survive intense conditions. Core gameplay revolves around exploration, mining, and strategic combat using passive defense mechanics inspired by Brotato and Vampire Survivor.

Gameplay Mechanics

Planet Selection

- **Standard Planets:**
 - In each run, players select 1 of 3 procedurally generated planets.
 - Distinct environmental characteristics (lava flows, ice caves, radioactive zones).
 - Used for resource mining, enemy encounters, and leveling up permanent upgrades.
- **Boss Planets:**
 - Four permanent planets containing ship components essential for repairing the Arc.
 - Persistent tunnels across multiple visits; incremental progress allowed.
 - Higher difficulty: tougher terrain, stronger enemies proportional to the planet's level.

Player Entry and Movement

- Players directly drop onto planet surfaces using:
 - Small landing craft (non-pilotable, cinematic entry).
 - Personal space suit equipped with a jetpack (to be finalized).

Exploration and Mining

- Worlds feature procedurally generated terrain including destructible landscapes and dynamically created underground tunnels:
 - Virgin soil: randomly generated free-form areas that ensure diverse and unique mining experiences every run.
 - Pre-dug tunnels: algorithmically placed structures featuring a combination of linear and branching paths, enemy encounter zones, and specialized rooms such as treasure vaults.

- Mining:
 - Resource gathering to craft upgrades and defenses.
 - Strategic mining is required to manage fuel, oxygen, and resource capacity.
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Combat and Defense System

Enemies

- **Ant-like creatures:** Basic threat, moderate speed, and damage.
- **Beetle-like creatures:** Armored; slow-moving but heavy damage resistance.
- **Elemental Monsters:** Adapt to planet type (lava, ice, radioactive, toxic); special abilities, and area effects.

Rooms and Encounters

- Larger rooms containing:
 - Rich resource deposits.
 - Miniboss encounters providing significant upgrade rewards.

Passive Defense System

- Players possess a suite of automatically firing weapons and abilities to handle enemy hordes.
 - Defensive upgrades include:
 - Orbiting drones and turrets.
 - Reactive armor and environmental shields.
 - Area control abilities (elemental fields, slowing zones, damage-over-time effects).
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Progression and Upgrades

- Permanent upgrades unlocked through mining, defeating minibosses, and surviving planetary challenges.
 - Upgrades enhance:
 - Mining efficiency.
 - Jetpack movement and fuel efficiency.
 - Passive defense capabilities (increased fire rate, damage, additional defensive units).
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Visual and Audio Style

- Atmospheric visuals tailored to planet themes.
- Bangin' follow-up soundtrack to the award-winning STRAYLIGHT OST
- Rich, ambient soundscapes enhance immersion and tension.
- Retro-inspired UI and aesthetics with modern fluid animations.

This document will serve as the foundational guide for further detailing individual systems and facilitating development planning.

Feedback

Repo/Game

GitHub: <https://github.com/danseery/rocket-rogue>

Playable Web Version:

https://wonderful-island-08d5ecb0f.7.azurestaticapps.net/rocket_rogue.html

Feedback

- Game Speed multiplier for testing
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